

Power Tips For Better Scanning

Scan Smart

Select your scanning area: Instead of placing a document or image and scanning the full area, always select the area to be scanned. This will reduce scanning time, as well as file size.

Resist scanning at high resolutions: If you intend to scan your documents only for viewing on a PC or on the Web, scanning at a resolution of 100 to 150 dpi is usually sufficient as monitors can only display at 72 dpi, and scanning at any higher resolution for this purpose would be useless. However, if you intend to print your images, you should scan at a higher resolution.

Using descreen: When you scan content from magazines or newspapers you will notice moiré patterns on the content. The best way to reduce this is by using the Descreen option that comes within the TWAIN drivers. If you have a scanner that does not have a descreen option in its scanning software, you can minimise this effect by applying it from an image-editing software.

Save format: First identify the target format you would like to save the image in. If you are using it for the Web or for animation, it would be appropriate to save it as a JPEG or GIF, as these save a lot of disk space. But if you would like to send the image for printing, TIFF is the best format as it can compress the image with no loss in image quality.

Correct ghost images: A ghost image occurs when the scanner picks up images from the back of a page. Often this can be corrected by changing the brightness and contrast controls. You will have to experiment to find the best setting of these controls for your particular scanner.

OCR scanning: Almost all scanners come with Optical Character Recognition software, but this is usually a stripped down version of a full package that the software company wants to sell you. Although these packages lack some of the sophistication of full-fledged OCR programs, they are much simpler to use. Simpler programs sometimes have problems with multiple columns of text, or documents that include photos and logos, etc. There's an easy solution to this. Photocopy the original and cut the columns into strips and remove the photographs. Now identifying the text for the OCR software will be much simpler.

Adjust brightness, contrast and sharpness:

Often you may notice that a bright image turns out pretty dull when scanned. This can be easily manipulated through the Twain driver (if it is supported), or through an image-editing software that lets

you increase the contrast and brightness levels so that the dull image looks much brighter.

Accessories for your Scanners

If you thought your scanner was intended just for scanning images, you'll be in for a surprise—you can do much more than casual scanning. All you need is a couple of accessories such as:

Transparency adapter: With this, you scan negatives, slides, and larger transparencies.

Automatic document feeder: This will let you feed a stack of pages for scanning without having to manually place each page on the scanner.

Software: Whether you need to use your scanner for faxing, copying, optical character recognition or graphics, you'll need the right software to do the job. Depending on what the manufacturer bundles with the scanner, you may need to buy additional software. Be sure to consider the added cost when comparing prices.

Care and Maintenance

If you find the images you are scanning are smeared with light or dark stripes, or displaying a chequerboard pattern, it's time you cleaned your scanner glass. In order to effectively clean the glass, unplug your scanner and raise the front lid. Apply a very mild streak-free cleaner to a soft lint-free cloth and clean the glass. Now, dry the glass with a soft cloth.

Do's:

- ✓ Always unplug your scanner before cleaning it
- ✓ Place your scanner away from heating vents or windows, or other locations where moisture might affect its functioning.
- ✓ Always keep the scanner on a level surface so that it has a good grip, otherwise the mechanism carrying the CCD and fluorescent lamp may get damaged over time

Don'ts:

- ✗ Never apply solution directly on the scanner glass. If you find that the glass is dirty or has a slight dust or smoke film underneath and on the inside, do not unscrew the lid and try to clean it from inside. It's always advisable to call an authorised service centre.
- ✗ Never use abrasives, isopropyl alcohol, benzene, acetone etc on the scanner glass, as this will streak and cloud the glass, and can even cause damage.
- ✗ Never place your scanner near heating vents or windows, or other locations where moisture might affect its functioning.

Also remember:

If you are moving the scanner from one place to another, make sure that the transportation lock is enabled, as this prevents the CCD array mechanism from moving. Push down the lock, which is located at the back of the scanner. Remember to unlock the scanner before you attempt to operate it, or you may end up damaging it.





hp ScanJet 3870c



Scan and create family albums.

